Review Checklist for Study Design

1. Does the study have a clear purpose or justification?

- When was the last study conducted on this topic? Space out the study to reduce fatigue on respondents and exercise prudence on the use of resources i.e. cost of study and additional workload on officers.
- Is conducting a study the best or only way to obtain the information needed, OR are there existing data sources, proxy indicators, or administrative data that could serve the same purpose?
- Is the information critical to decision-making, work planning, or policy development, or is it good-to-know? Will the Study Owner be able to act on the findings? Avoid asking the good-to-know. Ask the must-know. Only seek for critical information that you will utilise meaningfully.

Study Design & Methods

2. Are the questions or data points well-scoped and purposeful?

- Do all questions map directly to the key research questions or problem statement? Make sure that the information you seek will sufficiently meet the objectives of your study.
- Are good-to-know questions minimised or deprioritized to reduce respondent burden and survey fatigue?
- Are the questions clearly phrased, and is the answer format appropriate?
- Are there any critical questions that are missing?

3. Is the target population most suitable for the study's purposes?

- Is the target population clearly defined? Is the sample group most suitable for the information you are seeking?
- Are there any access or ethical considerations in reaching the target population (e.g., vulnerable groups)?

4. Is the expected sample size adequate for the planned analysis?

- Is the sampling approach (e.g., random, stratified) appropriate and clearly justified?

• For quantitative studies, is there a power calculation or justification for the sample size? • For qualitative studies, is the sample size sufficient for meaningful thematic analysis?
5. Is the proposed data collection method suitable for answering the study questions? • Is the method (e.g., survey, focus group discussion, secondary data analysis) justified given the nature of the study questions? • Are there practical or ethical constraints that make the chosen method more or less suitable? • Is burden placed on respondents by the proposed method justified against the potential gains of the study?

Note: Please reach out to research@ncss.gov.sg if you require further consultation